



Gamma RP

1st Edition

A simple roleplaying system meant to be dynamic and expandible

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Introduction

Gamma RP, or ΓRP, is a tabletop role-playing system meant to strike a balance between pure theater-of-the-mind systems and map based tabletop systems.

I've played many TTRPG systems, and I've found the most engaging systems for me were ones that had a visual element, but these by necessity often put a lot of burden of preparation on the moderator(s) of the game. They also can limit the amount of improvisation possible by the players.

I am a busy professional who daydreams a lot about worldbuilding. I wanted a system where any maps, items, or enemies could be very quickly created from scratch on-the-fly by an untrained game master.

So I spent a years' worth of free time creating ΓRP so that I could play a campaign I titled "Gamma Nebula" with my friends.

I need to make this introduction more sensible and legible, but for now this placeholder will suffice!

Enjoy!

Here is a purely tikz generated logo attempt:

Gamma RP, or ΓRP is so cool that I use it to preserve food in my refrigerator

The Basics

TRP is a tabletop role-playing game. This is a specific class of improvisational acting game in which the participants are divided into *Game Masters* and *Players*. Most games will require at least one game master in order to play the game, and the game master and players work together to tell a story.

The Game Master is responsible for constructing the world around the Players, and giving the players a setting to interact with. The Players are responsible for maintaining a Player Character— a character who interacts with and influences the setting defined by the Game Master.

Since the game is collaborative in this way, it is more fun and fair if the Game Master does not know the outcome of all actions in the setting. In order to fairly decide events where the outcome is unsure— TRP uses the roll of a set of dice to decide whether a course of action is successful.

2.1 The Fundamental Dice Mechanic

The fundamental dice mechanic in TRP is based on 12 sided dice. If you intend to play the game on a real physical tabletop, you may want to obtain a few dozen 12 sided dice.

Typically, the notation for a roll is written as $DXaY$

This means that you roll X 12 sided dice. If you receive a 12 on any dice, the roll is a success.

Y represents the *advantage* you receive on the roll. Higher numbers mean the roll is successful even at lower thresholds. An advantage of 1 is the default when advantage is not specified. This means that the roll as normal is only successful on a 12. However an advantage of 2 means the roll is successful on

any instance of a 12 or an 11 (there are two numbers now on which the roll is successful). In general an advantage of Y means the top Y numbers on the dice will count as a success. An advantage of 0 is the exception, which still is successful if any dice rolls a 12.

An advantage of 12 means that the roll automatically succeeds.

Advantage can also be negative. For convenience this is written as *disadvantage* which is the negative of the advantage. A roll of $DXa(-Z)$ is written equivalently as $DXdZ$.

A roll with at *disadvantage* of Z means that Z dice within the roll need to land on 12 for the roll to be successful. For example, with a roll of $D4d2$, 2 of the 4 dice need to land on 12 in order for the roll to be successful.

Note that the rolls $DXa1$, $DXa0$, $DXd1$ are all identical, requiring a single dice of the set to result 12 in order to result a success.

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Note that when the disadvantage is greater than the number of dice being rolled, the roll is an automatic failure.

With more than 2 disadvantage on any roll, the probability of a successful roll rapidly diminishes. A disadvantage of 12 or greater is considered an automatic failure for the roll (even though there is theoretically a chance of 12 twelve-sided dice all rolling 12). This is meant to simply be symmetric with the advantage mechanic where an advantage of 12 guarantees success.

In general, when a character has more than 2 disadvantage on a roll they will not succeed unless they use a dice modifying ability.

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